

Juan Carlos Muñoz-Mora

Professor of Development Economics · Universidad EAFIT, Colombia

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PROFILE

Scholar and development economist specializing in the **evaluation of social programs and public policy**. Combines **rigorous impact evaluation** (experimental and quasi-experimental designs) with **monitoring, measurement, and social-value analysis**, covering the full evaluation cycle—from design and field data collection to causal identification, learning, and decision-making. Integrates **micro-econometrics, data science**, and **mixed quantitative–qualitative methods**, applied across **agricultural and rural development, conflict, and climate change**, for multilateral organizations (World Bank, IDB, FAO, USAID) and governments in Latin America and Sub-Saharan Africa.

RESEARCH FIELDS

Development Economics · Agricultural & Rural Development · Economics of Conflict · Climate Change · Impact Evaluation · Micro-econometrics · Data Science · Mixed Methods

EDUCATION

2012--2016	PhD in Economics , ECARES – Université Libre de Bruxelles (ULB) & Universitat Pompeu Fabra (UPF) (<i>European Doctorate</i>)
2011--2012	Doctoral Training in Quantitative Economics (MSc equivalent), ECARES – ULB
2008--2010	MSc in Economics , Universidad de los Andes, Colombia
2001--2006	BSc in Economics , Universidad de Antioquia, Colombia

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

2019--present	Full Professor , Department of Economics, Universidad EAFIT, Colombia
2017--2019	Assistant Professor , Department of Economics, Universidad EAFIT, Colombia
2017--2019	Marie Curie Postdoctoral Research Fellow , Institute of Development Studies (IDS), University of Sussex, UK
2016--2017	Postdoctoral Research Fellow , Universitat Pompeu Fabra (UPF), Spain

ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP & ADMINISTRATION

2022--2026	Chair, Policy & Development Area , Universidad EAFIT
2019--2022	Director, PhD Program in Economics , Universidad EAFIT

TEACHING & THESIS SUPERVISION

Doctoral Thesis Supervision

ongoing	Germán Tabares , PhD in Economics, Universidad EAFIT
ongoing	Andrés Felipe Sánchez , PhD in Economics, Universidad EAFIT

AFFILIATIONS

2017--present	Research Associate, Institute of Development Studies (IDS), University of Sussex
2017--present	Institute of Political Economy and Governance (IPEG), Universitat Pompeu Fabra
2011--present	Households in Conflict Network (HiCN)

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles (International)

- “Being ready for climate change: determinants of climate change adaptation among smallholder farmers in Antioquia, Colombia” (2026), with Yazari Agudelo and Santiago Bohórquez Correa. *Environmental Research Communications*, 8(8), 085026. doi:10.1088/2515-7620/ae97e6
- “Managing destructive entrepreneurship in place: formal and informal institutions for the achievement of regional economic growth” (2025), with Sebastián Aparicio, Diego Martínez-Moya and David Urbano. *Small Business Economics*, 66(2), 565–588. doi:10.1007/s11187-025-01090-7

- “Education and land inequality: evidence on Colombian land tenure and human-capital formation” (2025), with Germán Tabares-Pozos and Irina España-Eljaiek. *Economic History of Developing Regions*, 40(1), 49–79. doi:10.1080/20780389.2025.2459909
- “From Local Voices to Global Impact” (2025), with Estefany Peña-Rojas and Andrés Felipe Sánchez-Saldarriaga. *The Journal of Public Space*, 10(1), 107–116. doi:10.32891/jps.v10i1.1854
- “The spatial interplay between productive and destructive entrepreneurship: do institutions meet expectations in rural areas?” (2024), with David Urbano, Sebastián Aparicio and Diego Martínez-Moya. *Entrepreneurship & Regional Development*, 37(3–4), 350–374. doi:10.1080/08985626.2024.2389378
- “Key Determinants of COVID-19 Vaccination Take-Up in Remote Rural Areas: Evidence From Colombia” (2024), with Natalia Cantet, Marcela Ibáñez and Laura María Quintero. *International Journal of Public Health*, 69, 1606689. doi:10.3389/ijph.2024.1606689
- “Control, dispute, and concentration of land during civil war: Evidence from Colombia” (2023), with José Fortou and Sandra Johansson. *International Interactions*, 49(2), 201–236. doi:10.1080/03050629.2023.2186406
- “From immigrants to local entrepreneurs: understanding the effects of migration on entrepreneurship in a highly informal country” (2022), with Sebastián Aparicio, Diego Martínez and David Urbano. *International Journal of Entrepreneurial Behavior & Research*, 28(9), 78–103. doi:10.1108/IJEBR-07-2021-0615
- “The role of land property rights in the war on illicit crops: Evidence from Colombia” (2018), with Santiago Tobón and Jesse d’Anjou. *World Development*, 103, 268–283. doi:10.1016/j.worlddev.2017.10.021
- “Returning Home after Civil War: Food security, nutrition, and poverty among Burundian households” (2018), with Philip Verwimp. *Journal of Development Studies*, 54(6), 1019–1040. doi:10.1080/00220388.2017.1311407
- “Prevalence, Economic Contribution, and Determinants of Trees on Farms across Sub-Saharan Africa” (2017), with Daniel C. Miller and Luc Christiaensen. *Forest Policy and Economics*, 84, 47–61. doi:10.1016/j.forpol.2016.12.005
- “The agriculture from economics: theoretical contributions to an old debate” (in Spanish, 2007), with Yady Barrero, Marleny Cardona, Ever Álvarez and Dorian Espinoza. *Revista Interamericana de Ambiente y Turismo*, 3(1). [link]

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles (Colombia)

- “Approaching the impact of armed conflict and illicit crops on the Colombian coffee sector” (in Spanish, 2015), with Ana María Ibáñez. *Ensayos de Economía Cafetera*, Federación Nacional de Cafeteros, 29. [link]
- “The price of land: state of the art in the economic valuation of rural land and its application in Colombia” (in Spanish, 2013), with Harold Cardona. *Suma de Negocios*, 4(1). [link]
- “Property taxes and economic development: property taxes and the investment of Antioquia’s municipalities” (in Spanish, 2013), with Santiago Tobón. *Ecos de Economía*, 17(36). [link]
- “Air pollution and vulnerability of exposed individuals: the case of downtown Medellín” (in Spanish, 2012), with Carlos Gaviria and Gabriel González. *Revista Nacional de Salud Pública*, 30(3). [link]
- “Is the economy a game? Experimental classroom evidence for an introductory economics course” (in Spanish, 2012), with Sebastián Aparicio and Manuel Mesa. *Ecos de Economía*, 15(33). [link]
- “The Paths of Coffee: Rural Armed Conflict and Colombian Coffee Production” (in Spanish, 2010). *Ensayos Sobre Política Económica*, 63. [link]
- “The effect of the Rural Armed Conflict on Colombian Coffee Production: a false myth?” (in Spanish, 2010). *Ensayos de Economía Cafetera*, Federación Nacional de Cafeteros, 26. [link]
- “Colombian labor market 2000–2006: an approach from signaling theory” (in Spanish, 2010), with Andrés Cano and Manuel Mesa. *Revista de la Educación Superior*, México. [link]
- “The environmental Kuznets curve for water quality: unit-root and co-integration tests” (2008), with Catalina Granda, Luis Guillermo Pérez and Mauricio Alviar. *Lecturas de Economía*, 66, 9–46. [link]
- “Land concentration and agricultural production in Antioquia, 1995–2004” (in Spanish, 2008), with Tatiana Mora. *Ecos de Economía*, 26. [link]
- “Labor productivity and territory: a spatial analysis for three productive sectors (1995–2005)” (in Spanish, 2007), with Marleny Cardona, Andrés Cano and Isabel Montes. *Economía, Gestión y Desarrollo*, 5. [link]
- “Forced displacement and rural land concentration in Antioquia, 1995–2004” (in Spanish, 2007), with Carlos Gaviria. *Lecturas de Economía*, 66. [link]
- “The environmental Kuznets curve for water quality in Colombia, 1980–2000” (in Spanish, 2005). *Revista Oikos*, 19. [link]

Books

- “This land is my land: understanding the effect of conflict on land tenure structure in Urabá-Antioquia” (in Spanish, 2021). Editorial Universidad EAFIT. doi:10.17230/9789587207101r0
- “Informality and Illegality in the gold-mining and wood industries in Antioquia” (in Spanish, 2012), with Jorge Giraldo. Editorial Universidad EAFIT. ISBN 978-958-99013-2-8. [link]
- “The atlas of rural property in Colombia 2000–2009” (in Spanish, 2012). Universidad de los Andes & Instituto Geográfico Agustín Codazzi. [link]

Book Chapters

- “Do trees on farms matter in African Agriculture?” (2018), with Daniel C. Miller and Luc Christiaensen. In L. Christiaensen & L. Demery (eds.), *Agriculture in Africa: Telling Myths from Facts*. Washington, DC: World Bank. [link]
- “The Persistence of Land Concentration in Colombia: What Happened Between 2000 and 2010?” (2011), with Ana María Ibáñez. In M. Bergsmo, C. Rodríguez-Garavito, P. Kalmanovitz & M. Saffon (eds.), *Distributive Justice in Transitions*. Torkel Opsahl / PRIO. ISBN 9780415521178. [link]

Other Publications (methodological)

- “Validity and Reliability of the Facility List Coder, a New Tool to Evaluate Community Food Environments” (2019), with Ana María Arcila and Andreu Farran. *Int. J. Environ. Res. Public Health*, 16(19), 3578. [link]
- “Best practices of statistical models in the Social Sciences: understanding the language of data” (in Spanish, 2017), with Sebastián Aparicio. In M. Cardona & J.C. Muñoz-Mora (eds.), *Aproximaciones Metodológicas en las Ciencias Sociales*. Universidad de Manizales.

WORKING PAPERS & WORK IN PROGRESS

- “*With the Peace in Sight: Strategic Land Expropriation Before Paramilitary Demobilisation in Colombia*”, with Lukas Kleine-Rueschkamp, Jesse d’Anjou and Andrés Sánchez-Saldarriaga. Submitted, *Journal of Development Economics* (2026).
- “*When Do Property Rights Reduce Illicit Crops? Market Connectivity as the Binding Constraint*”, with Eduard Martínez-González and María del Pilar López-Urbe. CEDE Working Paper 2026-37, Universidad de los Andes; under review, *Journal of Public Economics* (2026). [hdl:1992/79361](https://hdl.handle.net/1992/79361)
- “*Housing Investments and Well-being in Slums: Observational Evidence from Colombia*”, with Gustavo García, Albert Saiz, Juliana Lalinde-Velásquez and Daniela Mejía-Tejada. SSRN Working Paper (2025). [ssrn:5387296](https://ssrn.com/abstract=5387296)
- “*Does Storing Pay Off? Evidence from a Counterfactual Regression Discontinuity of Colombia’s Paddy Rice Storage Incentive (2013–2025)*”, with Daniela Mejía-Tejada, Daniel A. Rodríguez-Arbeláez, Nicolás Valbuena, Karen González, Stefany López, Lina Salazar, Gonzalo Rondinone, Rafael I. Parra-Peña and Carmine P. De Salvo. IDB Working Paper (2026). [doi:10.18235/0014440](https://doi.org/10.18235/0014440)
- “*The Property Tax Modernization Dilemma: A Decision-Support Framework for Equity and Revenue under Cadastral Reform*”, with Mónica Almonacid and Laura Peña. SSRN Working Paper (2026). [ssrn:6570319](https://ssrn.com/abstract=6570319)
- “*Healthy is Fresh: A Participatory Study of Meal Ideals and Barriers Shaping Food Choice in Rural Colombia*”, with Ana María Arcila-Agudelo, Harold Cardona-Trujillo et al. SSRN Working Paper (2026). [ssrn:6381888](https://ssrn.com/abstract=6381888)
- “*The European Union Deforestation Regulation (EUDR) and Colombian Smallholder Coffee Producers: Between Environmental Sustainability and Social Justice*”, with Harold Cardona-Trujillo and Paula Andrea Restrepo-Areiza. SSRN Working Paper (2026). [ssrn:6188818](https://ssrn.com/abstract=6188818)
- “*Building More Than Homes: How Interior Housing Upgrades Catalyze Welfare and Investment*”, with Albert Saiz, Juliana Lalinde-Velásquez, Daniela Mejía-Tejada, Gustavo García and Marcela Ibáñez. SSRN Working Paper (2026). [ssrn:6399298](https://ssrn.com/abstract=6399298)
- “*The Questionnaire as Treatment: Question Order and Measurement Bias in Development Surveys*”, with Marco Giani, Philip Verwimp, Daniela Mejía-Tejada and Laura Quintero. SSRN Working Paper (2026). [ssrn:6441737](https://ssrn.com/abstract=6441737)
- “*Measuring Without Accounting: SROI Compliance and the Limits of Social Value Reporting*”. SSRN Working Paper (2026). [ssrn:6388419](https://ssrn.com/abstract=6388419)
- “*Measuring Inequality from Above: introducing a new data set*”, with Marta Reynal-Querol and José G. Montalvo.
- “*Do trees on farms improve household welfare? Evidence from national panel data in Uganda*”, with Daniel C. Miller and Alberto Zezza.
- “*Civil War and Household Structure: evidence from Burundi*”, with Richard Akresh and Philip Verwimp.

RESEARCH REPORTS & POLICY PAPERS

- “*Territorial Inequalities in Colombia: Realities and Perspectives*” (2024), with Laura Giles-Álvarez, Cristhian Larrahondo, Mónica Hernández, Germán D. Angulo and Laura M. Quintero. Inter-American Development Bank. [doi:10.18235/0013019](https://doi.org/10.18235/0013019)
- “*Does Land Titling Matter? The Role of Land Property Rights in Colombia’s War on Drugs*” (2018). Policy Briefing, Institute of Development Studies, University of Sussex. [\[link\]](#)
- “*Inequality in Education, School Dropout and Adolescent Lives in Burundi*” (2014), with K. Cieslik, M. Giani, R.L. Ngenzebuke and P. Verwimp. UNICEF Burundi & Université Libre de Bruxelles. [\[link\]](#)
- “*Rural land tenure system in Antioquia, 2006–2011*” (2012), with Oswaldo Zapata. Universidad EAFIT & Gobernación de Antioquia.
- “*Urabá: abundance and dispute for land*” (2012), co-coordinated with Jorge Giraldo. Universidad EAFIT & Gobernación de Antioquia.
- “*Land taxes in Antioquia: toward an optimal design*” (2012), co-coordinated with Alberto Naranjo. Universidad EAFIT & Gobernación de Antioquia.
- “*The Persistence of Land Concentration in Colombia: What Happened Between 2000 and 2010?*” (2011), with Ana María Ibáñez. Notas de Política No. 9, Universidad de los Andes. [\[link\]](#)

SELECTED GRANTS, EVALUATIONS & CONSULTANCIES

2026	World Bank — Consultant. Bolivia Agricultural Public Expenditure Review (OECD-PSE analysis, 2006–2023).
2025--	Co-PI. Croppie: can AI increase farmers’ resilience to climate change? Impact evaluation with coffee farmers, with Alliance Bioversity–CIAT. Registered RCT (AEA RCT Registry #0016448).
2025--	Co-PI. It Takes a Family to Raise a (Digital) Village: experimental evidence with coffee farmers. Registered RCT (AEA RCT Registry #0016776).
2024	FAO — PI. Analytical monitoring mechanism for Colombia’s Agri-Food Supply System.
2024	IDB (BID) — PI. Territorial Inequalities in Colombia: Realities and Perspectives.
2023--2025	World Bank — Co-PI. Comprehensive analysis of Colombia’s agricultural development policy: results and spending efficiency.
2023	World Bank — Co-PI. Reorienting Paraguay’s agricultural policies for resilience and green growth.
2023--2024	IDB (BID) — Co-PI. Building Healthy Homes: the effect of housing improvement on practices that reduce conflict and prevent domestic violence.
2023--2024	Cementos Argos — PI. Impact evaluation of the Hogares Saludables program.
2023	FEDEPAPA / Minciencias — PI. Strategies and mechanisms for price stabilization in the potato sub-sector.
2022	IDB (BID) — PI. Mid-term evaluation of the Fondo Colombia Sostenible.
2022	IICA — Co-PI. Climate-resilient national/regional agricultural strategies and food availability.
2021--2022	IDB (BID) — Consultant. Pulso Social Colombia.

2021	USAID / NORC (U. Chicago) — <i>Country Expert</i> . Evaluation of the Land for Prosperity (LfP) Activity in Colombia.
2021--2022	University of Göttingen — <i>PI</i> . The natural-resource curse? Gold mining in Colombia.
2020--2024	BMBF (Germany) & Minciencias — <i>Principal Researcher</i> . Academic Network for Evaluating the Impact of Climate-Smart Agriculture in Colombia (NET-CSA).
2020	World Bank — <i>Co-PI</i> . Integrating Venezuelan Migrants in Colombia's Agri-Food Sector.

EARLIER RESEARCH POSITIONS

2015--2017	External Consultant, World Bank
2015--2016	Research Assistant for Prof. Marta Reynal-Querol, Universitat Pompeu Fabra
2014	Research Assistant for Prof. Philip Verwimp, UNICEF-Burundi
2011--2014	Early-Stage Researcher, TAMNEAC Network — European Commission (Marie Curie Actions)
2011	Senior Research Fellow, Universidad EAFIT
2010--2011	Junior Research Fellow, University of Antwerp
2008--2010	Research Assistant for Prof. Ana María Ibáñez, Universidad de los Andes
2006--2008	Research Assistant for Prof. Marleny Cardona, Universidad EAFIT
2005	Research Assistant for Prof. Mauricio Alviar, Universidad de Antioquia

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Invited Seminars & Presentations

2022	EAFIT; Banco de la República (Central Bank of Colombia)
2021	LACEA; Universitat de Barcelona
2019	University of Sussex; EAFIT; Banco de la República
2018	Oxford; University of Sussex; UPF; Banco de la República
2017	UPF; ECARES; IDS; Universitat de Barcelona; Banco de la República
2013--2016	UPF; FAO (Rome); Toulouse School of Economics; World Bank; ECARES-ULB; Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona; Universidad de Antioquia

Conferences & Workshops

2017--2018	Annual HiCN Workshop (Washington DC); BSE Jamboree, Barcelona
2014--2016	TAMNEAC Workshops (Brussels, Bogotá, Sussex); HiCN Workshops (UC Berkeley, New Delhi); Workshop on Geography & Armed Conflict, Uppsala University
2013	HiCN Workshop

Refereeing

World Development • Journal of Peace Research • Journal of Small Business and Entrepreneurship • Ecos de Economía • Cuadernos de Economía • Economía Institucional

HONORS & SCHOLARSHIPS

2017--2019	Individual Marie Skłodowska-Curie Fellowship — European Commission
2016	European Doctorate (UPF – ULB)
2014	Jorge Bernal Prize for Young Researchers
2011--2014	Marie Curie Fellowship — European Commission
2009	MICROCON Mobility Fund — European Commission

2008	Second Place, Revista Economía, Gestión y Desarrollo (U. Pontificia Bolivariana, Cali)
2006	First Place, Latin-American Economics Students' Paper Competition

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Languages	Spanish (native) · English (fluent)
Programming	R · Python · Stata · LaTeX · parallel computing
GIS & Field	QGIS · ArcGIS · Open Data Kit (ODK) · CSPro · Atlas.ti